

Kent Pearce

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Syllabus: [3360-20101\(001\)-syl.pdf](#)

Schedule: [3360-20101\(001\)-cal.pdf](#)

Homework: [3360-20101\(001\)-hwk.pdf](#)

Foundations of Algebra I

MATH 3360-001

Text

Papantonopoulou, A.

Algebra, Pure & Applied

Prentice-Hall

Lecture

Office Hours: MW 2:00 - 4:00 or
By Appointment

Room: MA 012
Time: MWF 11:00-11:50

Learning Objectives

Learning Outcomes: Students learn how to think and reason abstractly in the context of algebraic structures, and learn how to write correct and clear mathematical arguments in this context.

Concepts to be mastered by the students include but are not limited to the following:

- a. Groups and group homomorphisms
- b. Group actions
- c. Rings and ring homomorphisms
- d. Polynomials

Assessment of the learning outcomes

Assessment will be achieved through one or more activities, non-graded and graded, such as: class attendance, class discussion, board work, short quizzes, selected homework, writing assignments, examinations and other optional activities deemed appropriate by the instructor. Class grades will be assigned according to the following rubric:

Curricular Content**Chapter 0 – Background**

- a. Sets, Maps & Functions
Concepts: One-to-one, Onto, Image, Invertible
- b. Equivalence Relations & Partitions
Concepts: Reflexive, Symmetric, Transitive
- c. Properties of Integers
Principles: Well-Ordering Axiom, Mathematical Induction, Binomial Theorem, Division Algorithm, Euclidean Algorithm, Fundamental Theorem of Arithmetic, Modular Arithmetic
Concepts: Greatest Common Divisor, Least Common Multiple, Linear Combination

- d. Complex Numbers
Concepts: Real Part, Imaginary Part, Modulus, Conjugate,
- e. Matrices
Concepts: Matrix, Matrix Sum, Matrix Product, Invertible, Determinant

Chapter 1 – Groups

- a. Examples and Basic Concepts
Concepts: Operation, Group Axioms, Abelian, Group Tables, Order
Principles: Basic Group Properties
- b. Subgroups
Concepts: Subgroup, Cyclic Subgroup, Center
- c. Cyclic Groups
Concepts: Cyclic, Generator, Finite Order, Subgroup Lattice
- d. Permutations
Concepts: Permutation, Permutation Group (Symmetric Group of Degree n) S_n , Length, Cycle, Alternating Group of Degree n

Chapter 2 – Homomorphisms

- a. Cosets and Lagrange's Theorem
Concepts: Cosets, Index
Principles: Lagrange's Theorem
- b. Homomorphisms
Concepts: Homomorphism, Isomorphism
Principles: Basic Group Homomorphism Properties
- c. Normal Subgroups
Concepts: Normal Subgroup
- d. Quotient Groups
Concepts: Quotient Group
Principles: First Isomorphism Theorem, Cauchy's Theorem for Abelian Groups
- e. Automorphisms
Concepts: Automorphism, Inner Automorphism

Chapter 3 – Direct Products and Abelian Groups

- a. Examples and Definitions
Concepts: Direct Product
- b. Computing Orders
- c. Direct Sums
Concepts: Direct Sum
- d. Fundamental Theorem of Finite Abelian Groups
Concepts: Decomposable, Square-free
Principles: Fundamental Theorem of Finite Abelian Groups

Chapter 4 – Group Actions

- a. Group Actions and Cayley's Theorem
Concepts: Group Action,
Principles: Cayley's Theorem
- b. Stabilizers and Orbits under a Group Action
Concepts: Stabilizer, Orbit
- c. Burnside's Theorem and Applications
Concepts: Fixed
Principles: Burnside's Theorem
- d. Conjugacy Classes and the Class Equation
Concepts: Conjugate, Conjugacy Class
Principles: Class Equation
- e. Conjugacy in S_n and Simplicity of A_5
Concepts: Simple

Chapter 14 – Symmetries

- a. Linear Transformations
Concepts: Linear Transformation, Eigenvector, Eigenvalue, Transpose, Dot Product, Length, Distance, Orthogonal Group
- b. Isometries
Concepts: Rigid Motion, Isometry, Translations, Rotations, Reflections
- c. Symmetry Groups
Concepts: Group of Symmetries
Principles: Fixed Point Theorem
- d. Platonic Solids
Concepts: Regular Polyhedron, Platonic Solid, Dual

Chapter 6 – Rings

- a. Examples and Basic Concepts
Concepts: Ring, Commutative Ring, Ring with Unity, Subring
- b. Integral Domains
Concepts: Zero Divisor, Cancellation Laws, Integral Domain
- c. Fields
Concepts: Unit, Field, Subfield, Division Ring, Characteristic
Principles: Scarecrow's Theorem

Chapter 7 – Ring Homomorphisms

- a. Definitions and Basic Principles
Concepts: Ring Homomorphism, Kernel, Ring Isomorphism, Isomorphic

- b. Ideals
 Concepts: Ideal, Principal Ideal
 Principles: First Isomorphism Theorem for Rings

Chapter 8 – Ring of Polynomials

- a. Basic Concepts and Notation
 Concepts: Indeterminate, Polynomial, Value, Argument, Zero, Degree, Leading Coefficient, Rational Function
- b. Division Algorithm in $F[x]$
 Concepts: Quotient, Remainder, Divisor, Multiple, Factoring, Common Divisor, Relatively Prime
 Principles: Division Algorithm, Euclidean Algorithm
- c. More Applications of the Division Algorithm
 Concepts: Multiplicity, n th Roots of Unity
 Principles: Factor Theorem, Remainder Theorem
- d. Irreducible Polynomials
 Concepts: Primitive Polynomial
 Principles: Unique Factorization Theorem, Rational Roots Theorem

Grading

Examinations:

Mid-Term Exams	(September 24, Oct 15, Nov 12)	300 Pts.
Final Exam	(December 15, 1:30-4:30 pm)	200 Pts.

Home Work

6-10 Assignments, Various Dates	100 Pts.
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Writing Assignments

6-10 Assignments Various Dates, 4 will be returned for rewriting	100 Pts.
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Total Grade Point Base	700 Pts.
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Scale

A...100% - 90% B...89% - 80% C...79% - 70% D...69% - 60% F...59% - 0%

Critical Dates

September 13	Last Day to Drop on MyTech (Without Penalty)
October 11-12	Fall Break
October 25	Mid-Semester Grades Due
November 1	Last Day to Drop on MyTech (With Penalty)
November 24-25	Thanksgiving Break
December 2-8	Period of No Exams

Notices

Academic Integrity (Extracted from [OP 34.12](#))

It is the aim of the faculty of Texas Tech University to foster a spirit of complete honesty and high standard of integrity. The attempt of students to present as their own any work not honestly performed is regarded by the faculty and administration as a most serious offense and renders the offenders liable to serious consequences, possibly suspension.

“Scholastic dishonesty” includes, but it not limited to, cheating, plagiarism, collusion, falsifying academic records, misrepresenting facts, and any act designed to give unfair academic advantage to the student (such as, but not limited to, submission of essentially the same written assignment for two courses without the prior permission of the instructor) or the attempt to commit such an act.

Observance of Religious Holiday (Extracted from [OP 34.19](#))

A student who intends to observe a religious holy day should make that intention known in writing to the instructor prior to the absence. A student who is absent from classes for the observance of a religious holy day shall be allowed to take an examination or complete an assignment scheduled for that day within a reasonable time after the absence.

Accommodation for Students with Disabilities

Any student who, because of a disability, may require special arrangements in order to meet the course requirements should contact the instructor as soon as possible to make any necessary arrangements. Students should present appropriate verification from Student Disability Services during the instructor’s office hours. Please note instructors are not allowed to provide classroom accommodations to a student until appropriate verification from Student Disability Services has been provided. For additional information, you may contact the Student Disability Services office in 335 West Hall or 806-742-2405.